

Tips & Tricks

We let you in on Tips and Tricks for some unknown Google tools while also covering some tips for disinfecting your PC and more..

Workshop

We take on Android phone management in this month's workshop.

Display drivers breaking bad, WiFi connection drops, silly optical drives...

System issues or failing gadgets never seem to deter the good folks of team digit and thinkdigit forum and they come to the rescue to troubleshoot the digital lives of our readers.

Bad optical drive

Hello Team Digit. My laptop's optical drive is unable to read DVDs or CDs. Whenever I insert a disk I can hear a low level spinning noise but eventually it stops and nothing happens. The DVD drive is visible in windows explorer and the device manager as well. The device properties say that the drive is working properly. But unfortunately I'm unable to use it. Another problem is that I'm not able to close the drive's disc tray smoothly. I can eject the tray easily using a command or by manually doing it, but closing it seems to be a problem. Forcing the tray inwards gets it stuck and I feel some obstacle is blocking it. The tray goes in only after pushing it forcibly from the sides. I discovered these problems just a day after I received my laptop from SONY service centre. Please help.

-Yash Kher

A There is something definitely wrong with your laptop's optical drive. The optical drive's head might have an issue or it may have gotten damaged somehow. And regarding the disc tray, it seems that a part of the drive itself might be obstructing it. Since you recently gave your laptop for RMA, we think that something may have gone wrong during the laptop repairs. You should take it back to the service centre and get the drive repaired.

Pen drive malady

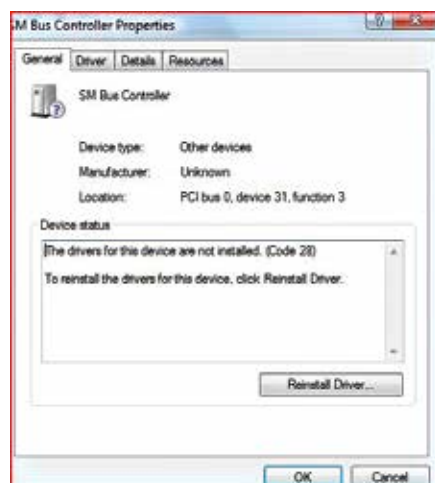
I am having trouble using a particular pen drive with my system. This pen drive works absolutely fine when I plug it in other systems but on my system, it gives me an

error saying "USB device not recognised". The port where I connected this drive is working properly because I can access other pen drives or external hard drives through that port. How should I make it work? Please let me know.

-sanny16 (tdf member)

A Looking at the properties of the pen drive, it seems that this is a driver issue. Code 28 is an error which indicates that drivers for a particular device are not installed. To fix this, first try and reinstall the latest chipset drivers from the manufacturer's website. You can also try to fix the issue by following the steps below: (You must be logged on as an administrator to perform these steps):

- Open Device Manager by right-clicking My Computer > Manage > Device Manager. If you're prompted for an administrator password or confirmation, type the password or provide confirmation.



Reinstall drivers from here.

- In the list of hardware categories, find the device that you want to update (in your case your pen drive) and then double-click the device name.
- Now click the Driver tab > Update Driver, and then follow the instructions.

After the process is complete, you should be able to access your pen drive.

WiFi connection drops

So I own a Belkin Basic router (802.11 n) and on my desktop I have a network interface card, the TP LINK WN350g (802.11 g). Now the problem I face is that, for some reason the internet connection keeps disconnecting. I have the latest drivers on both devices, I use a software called inSSIDer to check for any network interferences and it shows me that there are none. I use my iPad in the same room as my desktop and the Wifi on it works fine. Windows tray icon for Wifi Reception and inSSIDer both show three bars with the doors in between open, and with the doors closed. The wifi router is roughly 20 Feet away from my Desktop. For some reason I remember using the same card on my old desktop and it worked fine then. I can also see the same problem when I'm playing COD4 online where it says "Connection Interrupted". I didn't have these problems when I had my desktop in my old room on LAN with the same Wifi Router. Now my questions are:

- Could my network interface card be faulty?
- If yes, then will buying a n Network interface card solve the problem?
- In your opinion what should I buy? A Network interface card or a Wireless